

Hands-on Lab: Draft a Cover Letter

Estimated time needed: 15 minutes

Objectives

In this lab, you will draft a cover letter to accompany your resume.

Prerequisites

- For this lab, you have been provided with a Template/Answer sheet in Microsoft Word format. It is suggested that you have either MS Word installed on your computer or have a Microsoft 365 online account. You can also use other Word Processing application software, such as Google Docs, that allows you to open Word documents.
- Review the **Drafting a Cover Letter** video.

Instructions

The lab is divided into three tasks. You will start with collating the inputs for the cover letter. Then, you will add the details to the selected cover letter template.

Task 1: Cover letter inputs

Note: It is highly recommended that you create your base using the **Cover Letter Input Worksheet** to ensure all key information is captured. However, if you are confident about the key information for the cover letter, you can skip this step.

- Keeping the CTRL key pressed, click [here](#) to download the **Cover Letter Input Worksheet** Microsoft (MS) Word document.

Note: Use the COMMAND key instead of CTRL on Mac systems.

- Review the columns in the **Cover Letter Input Worksheet** document.
 - Cover Letter Entry** lists the key information that must be captured in the cover letter.
 - Example** of details in a given key cover letter area.
 - Your Input** to enable you to add your details.

Cover Letter Entry	Entry Example	Your Input
Greeting	Dear Ms. Ericson:	
Introduction: Job Description and How You Fit	I was excited when my University batchmate Jenna Madison informed me about the current opening for a Cybersecurity Specialist at your organization. Having worked as a Technical Support Engineer for the past two years, I have expanded my skillset to enter the cybersecurity field.	
Build a Case for Your Strengths	I have taken some cybersecurity classes and cleared the Certified in Cybersecurity (CC) exam. I am eager to learn and contribute to the cybersecurity initiatives at your organization. I have been able to establish good rapport with the extended teams and maintain a good relationship with customers. I am a team player and love challenges.	
Closing	Thank you for your consideration. I would love to join the cybersecurity team at Magnuson Software, and I look forward to discussing how I can be an asset to the team. Best regards Antonio Fernandes	

- Enter your details.
- Save the file.

Task 2: Add details in the selected cover letter template

Next, transfer the details to a cover letter template.

Step 1: Select a cover letter template you prefer

- Search for cover letter templates online.

Note: Several websites, such as Microsoft.com, offer resume and cover letter templates at no cost.
- Select a template that meets your needs.

Step 2: Draft the cover letter

1. Add the key information from the **Cover Letter Input Worksheet** to the selected template.
2. Save the cover letter for future use.

Note: Depending on the job requirements, you can refine the cover letter to increase your chances to be shortlisted for an interview.

Step 3: [Optional] Share your cover letter for feedback

1. Share your cover letter with peers, family, and friends.
2. Assess the feedback and update your cover letter as needed.

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